

Sold 10% of Apple in 1976

EVERYBODY KNOWS WHO Steve Jobs is. If you follow technology, you also know who Steve Wozniak is.

Do you have any idea who Ronald Wayne is?

In April 1976, Wayne was the third co-founder and 10% shareholder of Apple Computer. For reasons that are both interesting and relevant to our discussion here, he sold his stake for a mere \$800.^{[236](#)} Had he held on to it, that 10% stake of Apple stock was worth \$329 billion 40 years later in 2016.

I'll let that seep into your brain for a minute... \$800 into \$329 billion.

This may possibly be the worst stock trade—ever.

There are lessons for all of us in this. Before we get to those, a brief digression.

Apple was born almost 50 years ago, on April Fools' Day 1976. The story of Jobs, the marketing genius/visionary, and Wozniak, the brilliant engineer/hacker, toiling away in a garage is well-known Silicon Valley lore. But less well-known history is that of Wayne, the third partner, who was there from day one.

His contributions were not insignificant: He designed the company's logo, wrote the Apple 1 computer user's manual, and drafted the company's original partnership agreement. But after less than two weeks with Apple, he'd had enough of the Steves, and on April 12, Wayne sold his stake for \$800. In Wozniak's autobiography,^{[237](#)} he described Wayne's contribution: "Ron ended up playing a huge role in those very early days at Apple."

Wayne's departure sets us up to learn some lessons from this incredible but true story.